

Scenario:

Customer tries to transfer ₹50,000.

Transaction failed.

Error shown: "Transaction could not be completed."

Expected discoveries:

1. Daily limit exceeded
2. Insufficient balance
3. Bank server unavailable
4. OTP expired
5. Network timeout
6. Beneficiary inactive
7. Fraud rule triggered
8. Core banking unavailable
9. UPI switch unavailable

PROMPT USED:

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Transaction failed.

Error shown: "Transaction could not be completed."

Identify what needs investigation by Thinking step by step/CoT

RESULT :

Think Step by Step – Identify What Needs Investigation

1. Verify the transaction status

- Confirm whether the transaction is genuinely marked as **Failed** in the backend/system.

2. Check the customer's account balance

- Verify whether the customer had sufficient available balance for the ₹50,000 transfer.

3. Check transaction limits

- Verify whether ₹50,000 exceeds the customer's daily, per-transaction, or account-specific transfer limit.

4. Check beneficiary details

- Confirm that the beneficiary account is valid and active.

5. Check authentication/authorization

- Verify whether OTP, PIN, MFA, or other authorization requirements were successfully completed.

6. Check backend/API response

- Review logs and API responses to identify whether the failure originated from the application, payment service, or banking service.

7. Check network/service availability

- Determine whether there was a timeout, connectivity issue, or downstream service outage.

8. Check account debit

- Confirm that ₹50,000 was **not deducted** despite the transaction being marked as failed.

9. Check error handling

- Verify whether the generic error message is appropriate and whether a more meaningful message should be displayed.

10. Check retry/recovery

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- Verify whether the customer can safely retry the transaction without creating a duplicate transfer.

Final investigation areas

**Balance → Transaction limits → Beneficiary → Authentication → API/Backend →
Network → Debit status → Error handling → Retry**